

Cyber-Phenomenology: Presence, Embodiment, and Mediation

Cyber-Phenomenology: Presence, Embodiment, and Mediation I

DigiPPPiP changes the phenomenology of shared drawing. In co-present PPPiP, the partner's mark arrives with posture, breath, hesitation, and ambient bodily cues. In remote DigiPPPiP, the mark arrives through a mediated surface. This does not make the practice unreal; it changes how embodiment is distributed across body, tool, screen, and archive. Phenomenology of embodiment gives the theoretical background for treating tools and media as extensions of bodily agency [Merleau-Ponty 2012 phenomenology], while presence research distinguishes social richness, mediated immediacy, and shared-space illusions as design variables rather than guarantees of togetherness [Lombard 1997 presence; Biocca 1997 cyborg; Lee 2004 presence].

Cyber-Phenomenology: Presence, Embodiment, and Mediation II

Telepresence and re-embodiment are central. A remote shared canvas carries traces of the partner's motor act, while video, voice, latency, cursor trails, stroke halos, and replay create additional layers of presence and absence [lombard1997presence;biocca1997cyborg;lee2004presence]. The concept of digitally mediated or marbled embodiment helps avoid a simplistic hierarchy in which physical co-presence is always authentic and remote connection is always degraded [atuk2024bodiesonline]. Video-mediated collaborative drawing also shows that screen action is not merely a visual output; it is part of how participants make proposals, invite co-participation, and coordinate who has practical control of the emerging drawing [oittinen2025videodrawing]. A DigiPPPiP system can support social presence without photorealistic avatars by using lightweight, privacy-preserving cues: labeled cursors, delayed traces, visible turn-taking, and explicit tool-control state.

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The same cues can fail phenomenologically. A cursor trail can feel intimate when it makes hesitation visible, but invasive when it makes every micro-movement inspectable. A replay can help partners revisit a moment, but it can also convert a fragile exchange into evidence to be judged later. DigiPPPiP therefore needs a phenomenology of control as much as a phenomenology of presence: partners should know when they are visible, when traces persist, and when a mark can be withdrawn.

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Privacy is not just a settings panel in this account. Contextual-integrity theory treats privacy as appropriate information flow within a social context, while networked-privacy work treats privacy as a dynamic boundary-management process rather than a simple public/private switch [Nissenbaum 2011 contextual privacy; Palen 2003 privacy]. Communication Privacy Management theory is especially relevant for partner drawing because the artifact can become co-owned: one partner's expressive mark may disclose something about both partners, and later sharing may require negotiated rules rather than unilateral export [Petronio 2020 cpm]. A DigiPPPiP archive is therefore phenomenologically legitimate only when persistence, replay, and deletion preserve the dyad's felt control over the trace.

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This matters most for asynchronous practice. The gap between contributions becomes part of the event structure: the absence after a mark creates expectation; the next mark answers it. The formal appendix describes this as curiosity, epistemic action, and co-discovery under an expected-information-gain arc [sec:formalism_appendix]. The phenomenological hypothesis is that waiting can intensify, not merely interrupt, dyadic meaning when the shared artifact remains stable and intentional. That claim should be tested with presence measures and qualitative accounts; it should not be generalized from theory alone.